

Exploring Gen X (46-60)

User Research Shareout, 29/4/2026 

Shira Kedem

The **bridge generation** - raised analog, living digital

65M

Americans
born 1965-1980

\$101K

Highest median household
income of any generation

42%

Have both an aging
parent and a child

Technology is already a **big part** of their daily life - as any other **younger** generation

91%

of adults 50+ own a smartphone - same rate as younger adults

66%

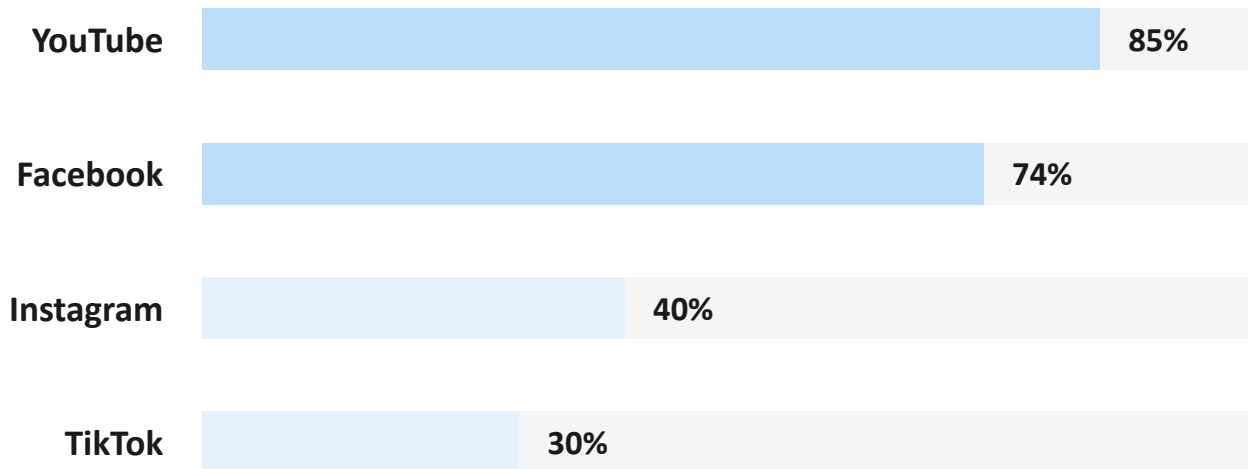
say technology makes daily life and aging easier

7

devices owned on average per person aged 50+

Present on social media - across every major platform

54% of 50-64 year olds use Facebook daily. YouTube is their #1 platform.



It's about **family** - not followers

51%

use social media primarily
to stay in touch with family

23% friends

12% acquaintances

11% colleagues

4% new people

Photos shared are of family events, vacations, milestones - not personal branding.

What gets in the way?

Visual

Small text, low contrast, light UI

Motor

Small tap targets, precise gestures needed

Cognitive

Complex navigation, hidden features, overload

Trust

Privacy concerns, data use worries, AI skepticism

**Unmoderated sessions
with FT older users**

What we heard from our older users?

Study setup

9 participants

8 aged 46-60, 1 aged 71

3 unmoderated tests

Free editing, Looks + Retouch, Specific tasks

All Facetune users

Recruited via UserTesting

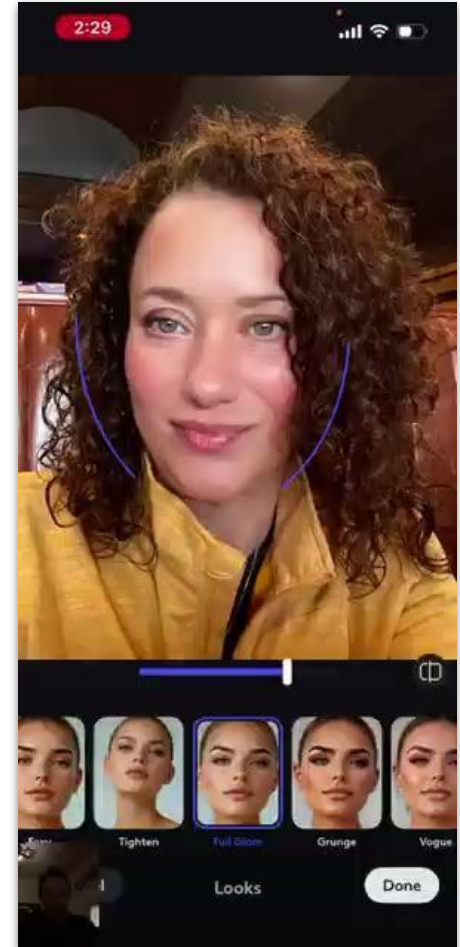
Goal

Identify key pain points and unmet needs users aged 46-60 encounter during a typical Facetune editing session.

*Limitations: Small sample. Each group had a slightly different task flow due to difficulty recruiting this audience and changes in direction between tests.

They want to look like **themselves** - just a bit better

Gen X users don't want to look way younger in an unrealistic way. They want to look fresh and natural - like a good version of themselves that people will still recognize.



Users valued the **intensity slider**

It gave them control over how far an edit goes, and allowed to pull back before results feel "too much."

"I like the little slider to adjust each of the filters."

49 years old

"I like that option of having that little slide bar to go over just to see how it looks and where you may wanna stop."

55 years old

"You gave us a lot of control... we could use it a little bit or a lot."

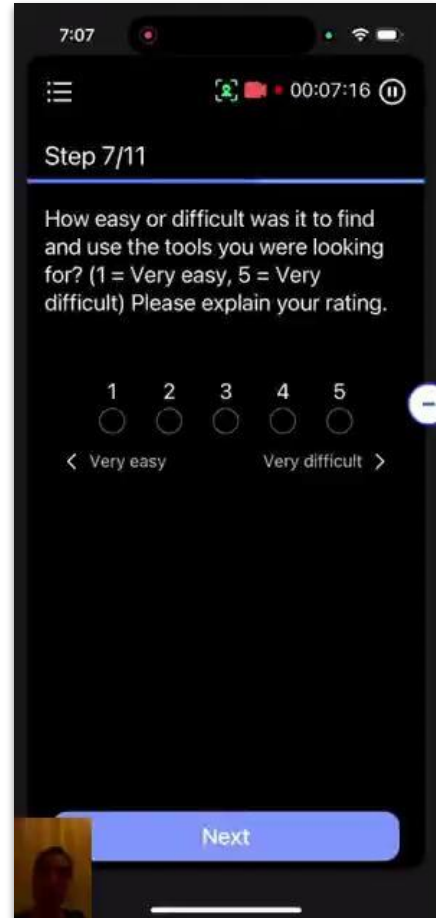
56 years old

The editor menu can be **complex** and too full of tools

Users rated the editing tools as **easy**. The one usability struggle was **navigating the menu**.

“The menu is too big”, categories are confusing

Users find the same function in multiple places and don't know which one to use.



What to **keep in mind**

They want to look like themselves on a good day

Results that feel fake or unrecognizable break trust. Consider adding 'Looks' presets that feel age-appropriate and subtle.

Simple navigation over feature count

A packed menu with duplicate tools creates confusion and overload. Consider streamlining the menu to surface only the most-used tools for this age group.

Older users need a different UI

We should try to avoid small text, low contrast, and interactions that require precise gestures.

New User Overview

User Age Distribution by Cohort Week

Explore

